BISM1201

Transforming Business with Information Systems

Assignment

Semester 1, 2024

Course Coordinator: Associate Professor Stan Karanasios

Assignment Specification Semester 1, 2024

Individual Completion: This assignment is to be completed individually by each student. Students are encouraged to discuss issues that arise in this course together, however, the written work you submit must be entirely your own. Similarly, you must not help another student to cheat by sharing assignments (present or past).

Due Date The assignment is due by Tuesday March 26, 2024, at 3PM (Brisbane time). Submissions after this date and time will be considered "Late" and relevant penalties will apply.

Submission

To be done through Blackboard Assignment Submission and TurnItIn as indicated in Learn.UQ.

Acceptable submission formats are Microsoft Word and PDF formats. The files **MUST** be named in the format of **BISM1201_StudentLastName_StudentID.pdf (or a. docx or .doc extension)**. If your ID is 41724943 and your Lastname is Smith, the name of your files would be **BISM1201_Smith_41724943.pdf**.

You can submit your work multiple times prior to submission in order to obtain a Turnitin report to confirm there is no accidental plagiarism (we only mark the last submission).

No hardcopy or email submission is required or accepted.

For information on how to submit:

https://web.library.uq.edu.au/library-services/it/learnuq-blackboard-help/learnuq-assessment/blackboard-assignments/assignment-submission-instructions

https://web.library.uq.edu.au/library-services/it/learnuq-blackboard-help/learnuq-assessment/turnitin-assignments

Presentation

- You must follow the word length requirements (+/-10%).
- Your assignment must be presented using the sections for Question 1 and Question 2.
- Be sure to use double-spacing, 12-point font, page numbering and 2.5cm margins on all sides of the page.
- Please proofread your assignment for spelling and grammatical errors.

Referencing and Citing

The questions require you to do basic analysis of the case. You must base your answers and terminology on the material covered in our weeks of information systems theory.

If you wish to report another author's point of view you should do so in your own words, and properly reference in accordance with an approved referencing style. Direct quotations should be used sparingly, form a small part of your work, and must be placed in quotation marks and referenced.

Question 1 requires you to give a real-world example. Examples can come from journals, newspapers, organisation websites, magazines etc. The real-world examples must be referenced

using in-text refencing and included in the reference list at the end of the assignment. For example, "*Nike uses a product differentiation information system strategy because it allows customers to use its online platform to customise its sneakers. This means that Nike can use information systems to offer a different value proposition than its competitors (Smith & Chang, 2010)*".

For more information on referencing styles, visit the library or see: https://web.library.uq.edu.au/research-tools-techniques/referencing/referencing-style-guides. Use the **UQ Harvard** style. You may use other styles but be consistent throughout and ensure the reader and find the source you cite.

UQ value academic integrity, referencing others work is a key part of this. Please see this link for more information on academic integrity: https://my.uq.edu.au/information-and-services/manage-my-program/student-integrity-and-conduct/academic-integrity-and-student-conduct.

Case: GreenMe: Pioneering Sustainable Energy Solutions

GreenMe Innovations is a family-operated enterprise that specializes in developing and installing custom sustainable energy solutions for residential and commercial clients. Unlike major energy companies, GreenMe's approach is highly personalized, offering consultations and installations tailored to each customer's specific needs. Clients typically engage with GreenMe through in-person consultations at their office in Brisbane or on-site evaluations at the client's location.

A challenge for GreenMe arose during the economic slowdown caused by the COVID-19 pandemic in 2020-2021. As a business heavily reliant on on-site assessments and face-to-face interactions, GreenMe experienced a downturn in client engagements. Concurrently, there was an increasing public interest in sustainable living and energy efficiency, a market trend that GreenMe was unable to fully capitalize on due to its traditional business model.

After conducting an analysis using Porter's Five Forces, GreenMe recognized the competitive pressure from emerging online renewable energy service providers and larger, more established companies. This prompted the company to reconsider its growth and modernization strategies. While GreenMe has always served a niche market of environmentally conscious clients, the growing awareness and demand for green energy solutions present a significant opportunity for expansion. At the same time, the GreenMe is hearing lots of hype around technology such as AI, blockchain, big data analytics and ERP and is wondering whether it should just invest in these technologies.

One of GreenMe's primary challenges is its digital infrastructure, which has remained basic and outdated. GreenMe recognises that it is not 'digitally ready.' The company has relied on rudimentary tools for scheduling, client communication, and project management, such as Excel. This limited digital adoption has hindered GreenMe's operational efficiency and ability to scale its services. The lack of an integrated Customer Relationship Management system means client interactions and historical data are not recorded, leading to gaps in customer relationship management and business

intelligence. Similarly, supply chain interactions and inventory management for equipment and materials are handled manually, slowing down project timelines.

The owners of GreenMe are now considering how to evolve the business to meet current market demands and are planning to reduce their involvement in day-to-day operations. They recognise the need for more sophisticated and automated processes.

GreenMe has recruited you as a business analyst. Your role is to advise on the adoption and implementation of advanced information systems. The owners would like advice on different information systems strategies that can help the firm modernise itself and make the most of the demand for its products. In particular, they want to streamline current operations but also enable GreenMe to leverage emerging market opportunities in the sustainable energy sector. They also want to better understand if they should choose a technology or define a strategy first.

Your task:

Question 1: Select one of the below information systems strategies and explain how it can help GreenMe be more competitive.

(i) Basic strategy/align IT with business objectives;
(ii) Low-cost leadership;
(iii) Product differentiation;
(iv) Focus on market niche;
(v) Strengthen customer or supplier intimacy.

Provide a real-world example[1] for the information systems strategy you identified and show how it is applicable to the case of GreenMe.

Use at least two academic references in your answer.

(600 words total) (15 marks).

Question 2: Explain which should management prioritize: selecting a specific technology or defining their strategy?

You do not need to use references in this answer.

(200 words total) (5 marks).

Marking Rubric

This assignment is worth 20 marks. The marking rubric on the next page is designed to reflect a marking schema of 100 percent that is scaled back to 20 marks. Part marks are rounded up or down to the nearest half mark.

[1] You should reference your example. Examples should not be from the course textbook (or seminar/tutorial material). The examples can come from any context, that is they do not have to be about energy or small firms.

MARKING RUBRIC

Assessed out of 100 points and scaled back to 20 marks (part marks are rounded up or down to the nearest half mark).

Criteria	Below Expectations (0% to 50%)	Meets Expectations (50% to 70%)	Very Good (70% to 90%)	Outstanding (>90%)
Question 1: Strategy explanation **6 Marks**	Inadequate explanation of strategy's role in competitive advantage or its relevance to the case.	Basic explanation of a strategy and its competitive advantage, but weak connection to the case. Evidence cited but can be improved.	Well-explained strategy showing how it provides competitive advantage in the case context. Evidence cited.	Exceptionally clear explanation of strategy's competitive advantage and direct relevance to the case. Evidence cited.
Question 1: Example and link to case **6 Marks**	No clear link between strategy and provided examples. Poor referencing	Example provided is somewhat relevant but has gaps. Appropriately referenced.	Example is relevant and demonstrates a partial link to the strategy in the case. Appropriately referenced.	Example is highly relevant, effectively demonstrates strategy application to the case. Appropriately referenced.
Question 1: Writing and presentation **3 Marks**	Lacks clear structure. Unprofessional tone and presentation at times. Major errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Inadequate logic/flow between sections.	Basic structure evident with some signposting Professional tone and presentation. Some errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Adequate logic/flow between sections.	Good structure with clear signposting. Professional and well-presented writing. Few errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Strong logic/flow between sections.	Excellent structure, well-signposted, with coherent linking of paragraphs or clear headings. Exceptionally professional tone and outstanding presentation. Very occasional errors. Strong, coherent logic/flow between sections.
Question 2: Argument quality **4 Marks**	Incorrect answer with weak argumentation.	Correct response with some gaps in argumentation.	Correct response with a clear and solid argument.	Correct and well-articulated argument.
Writing and presentation **1 Mark**	Lacks clear structure. Unprofessional tone and presentation at times. Major errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Inadequate logic/flow between sections.	Basic structure evident with some signposting Professional tone and presentation. Some errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Adequate logic/flow between sections.	Good structure with clear signposting. Professional and well-presented writing. Few errors in spelling, grammar, and referencing. Strong logic/flow between sections.	Excellent structure, well-signposted, with coherent linking of paragraphs or clear headings. Exceptionally professional tone and outstanding presentation. Very occasional errors. Strong, coherent logic/flow between sections.

END OF ASSIGNMENT